

Book II - The Spiral and the Block

Part 1 - The True Republic

## Chapter 06 - Would Society Collapse Without Government

### EP03 — Would Society Collapse Without Government?

**Series:** True Republic **Type:** Street / Campus Interview **Core Question:** "Would society collapse without government?"

#### The Seed Being Planted

This is the most common objection to voluntaryism. Most people assume order requires a central authority to impose it — because that's the only model they've been shown.

The Living Age thesis is that order emerges from the bottom up in complex living systems. Forests, brains, markets, and the internet all produce coordination without a ruler. The question plants the seed: what if society is a living system, not a machine that needs a driver?

#### Interview Arc

##### Opening Question

"Do you think society would collapse if there were no government?"

##### Follow-Up Questions

- "What specifically would collapse — can you name it?"
- "Who currently provides that, and could anyone else?"
- "Do you cooperate with your neighbors because the law tells you to, or for other reasons?"

- "Has a government ever collapsed? What happened to the people?"
- "Are there things people do together — voluntarily — that governments don't provide?"
- "Is it possible that some of what government does works despite being forced, not because of it?"

### **The Contradiction That Often Emerges**

People point to roads, schools, and safety — then realize these exist in various private or community forms elsewhere. The assumption that government is the only possible source of these things is the collapse point. The ant colony has no queen commanding the workers.

### **Cold Open Script (Narrator)**

*"Forests have no government. Brains have no central ruler. Ant colonies have no commander telling each ant what to do. And yet — they work. So when someone says society would collapse without rulers... what exactly are they assuming about people?"*

### **Closing Narration**

The shaken jar convinces ants that without the jar, there is only chaos. But the jar is not what keeps them alive — it's what traps them. Living systems self-organize. The question is whether we've been inside the jar long enough to forget what we're capable of.

### **Source Quotes**

*Direct quotes from Sage's own writing to draw from when scripting this episode.*

*"The difference between living things and machines is that living things just need to be allowed to grow and machines require constant effort to keep working. If you treat either as the other it will break."*

*"If we understand nature's code we could design things in nature's way not in the way of empire. Society is a living system and it should act as one."*

*"They forged systems that mirrored their minds: open, adaptive, and free. They built decentralized markets because no one would give them a place in the rigid hierarchies of the old world. And when that world fell — as all false empires do — only their creation remained."*

*"Every part in a living system has an individual purpose and no part of the living system is above another but they are all equal but perform different functions."*

*"Governed by the law of voluntary harmony — where genius is not permissioned, and every spark has the right to shine."*

*"People are like cells in a body — I will use that concept and apply the principles of bioinformatics to help guide people toward their individualized choices."*

*The Living Age Trilogy*